

GENERAL ENGLISH (IDIOMS & PHRASES SERIES)

PRACTICE SHEET MEDIUM LEVEL (SET 3) / INTERMEDIATE IDIOMS & MEANINGS (30 QUESTIONS)

1. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Back to the drawing board"

- (A) Starting a plan over because the previous one failed
- (B) Drawing architectural sketches for new buildings
- (C) Returning to school classrooms for art classes
- (D) Reviewing whiteboard presentations with managers

2. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Ball is in your court"

- (A) It is your turn to take action or make a decision
- (B) You must play tennis outdoors with friends
- (C) Someone else is responsible for your mistakes
- (D) The sports match has been postponed

3. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Barking up the wrong tree"

- (A) Looking in the wrong place or accusing the wrong person
- (B) Training hunting dogs in dense woodlands
- (C) Shouting loudly at inanimate park trees
- (D) Climbing unstable ladders at a construction site

4. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Beating a dead horse"

- (A) Wasting energy on an issue that has already been settled
- (B) Mistreating farm animals during agricultural work
- (C) Continuing a sports race with injured horses
- (D) Trying to revive old technology products

5. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Best of both worlds"

- (A) Enjoying the advantages of two different opportunities simultaneously
- (B) Traveling to two foreign countries in one vacation
- (C) Owning two houses in separate neighborhoods
- (D) Balancing hard work with regular leisure time

6. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Bite the bullet"

- (A) To endure a painful or difficult situation with courage
- (B) To bite metal objects during military training
- (C) To shoot firearms hastily during combat
- (D) To accept a financial loss without complaining

7. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Break a leg"

- (A) A phrase wishing someone good luck, especially performers
- (B) A warning about dangerous physical sports
- (C) A curse directed at rival competitors
- (D) An accidental injury during rehearsal

8. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Bury the hatchet"

- (A) To make peace and end an argument or feud
- (B) To hide weapons after a battle
- (C) To bury old tools in garden soil
- (D) To forget historical events permanently

9. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Call it a day"

- (A) To stop working on something for the rest of the day
- (B) To finish daily calendar schedules
- (C) To announce sunset during evening walks
- (D) To celebrate a successful birthday event

10. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Caught between a rock and a hard place"

- (A) Stuck in a difficult choice between two undesirable options
- (B) Trapped inside a narrow mountain cave
- (C) Performing heavy construction labor
- (D) Resting uncomfortably on rocky ground

11. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Cost an arm and a leg"

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|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| (A) To be extremely expensive | (B) To require intense physical labor |
| (C) To cause severe bodily injuries | (D) To trade valuable items for cash |

12. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Cry over spilled milk"

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| (A) To complain about a past loss that cannot be changed | (B) To waste dairy products during breakfast preparation |
| (C) To clean up kitchen spills immediately | (D) To cry when drinking cold beverages |

13. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Cut corners"

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|---|--|
| (A) To do something poorly or cheaply to save time or money | (B) To take sharp turns while driving cars |
| (C) To trim rectangular paper sheets accurately | (D) To shorten walking routes through alleys |

14. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Cutting edge"

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|--|---|
| (A) Highly advanced, innovative, or modern | (B) Sharp tools used in surgical procedures |
| (C) Dangerous industrial machinery | (D) Edges of newly sharpened knives |

15. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Don't judge a book by its cover"

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|--|---|
| (A) Do not judge someone or something solely based on appearance | (B) Reading books requires examining book jackets |
| (C) Library books should be protected from damage | (D) Visual designs are more important than text content |

16. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Double whammy"

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|---|--|
| (A) Two problems or setbacks happening at the same time | (B) Winning two prizes in a lottery draw |
| (C) A powerful punch delivered in combat sports | (D) Repeating words during a speech |

17. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Drop the ball"

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|--|---|
| (A) To make a careless mistake or fail in a responsibility | (B) To fumble a sports ball during a match |
| (C) To drop fragile items on the floor | (D) To release control of a project intentionally |

18. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Elvis has left the building"

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|--|---|
| (A) The event or show has completely ended | (B) A famous singer has departed backstage |
| (C) Security guards have cleared an arena | (D) Audiences are leaving concert halls early |

19. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Flog a dead horse"

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|---|---------------------------------------|
| (A) To waste effort on something hopeless or finished | (B) To abuse animals during transport |
| (C) To try reviving historical legends | (D) To repeat arguments endlessly |

20. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Get out of hand"

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|---|--------------------------------------|
| (A) To become uncontrollable or chaotic | (B) To lose physical grip on objects |
| (C) To dismiss staff members from work | (D) To finish manual tasks quickly |

21. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Give the benefit of the doubt"

- (A) To believe someone's innocence without absolute proof (B) To accuse someone of hidden dishonesty
(C) To question someone's credibility publicly (D) To offer financial help during hard times

22. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Go down in flames"

- (A) To fail spectacularly and completely (B) To survive a major building fire
(C) To crash an aircraft during flight (D) To lose money in stock markets

23. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Good things come to those who wait"

- (A) Patience is rewarded with positive outcomes (B) Waiting in lines takes too much time
(C) Fast workers always achieve success (D) Opportunities pass quickly if ignored

24. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Hear it through the grapevine"

- (A) To learn news through informal rumors or gossip (B) To harvest grapes on a vineyard farm
(C) To listen to secret radio broadcasts (D) To overhear official announcements

25. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Hit the nail on the head"

- (A) To find or state the exact truth or correct answer (B) To injure your thumbs during carpentry
(C) To build wooden furniture skillfully (D) To make a severe analytical error

26. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Hit the sack"

- (A) To go to bed to sleep (B) To punch sports punching bags
(C) To pack luggage for travel (D) To finish late-night shifts

27. What is the meaning of the idiom: "In the nick of time"

- (A) Just before a deadline or catastrophe occurs (B) Arriving extremely early for appointments
(C) Wasting hours on unimportant tasks (D) Measuring precise seconds on stopwatches

28. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Jump the gun"

- (A) To act too hastily before the appropriate time (B) To start a sports race prematurely
(C) To fire weapons without permission (D) To panic during emergency situations

29. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Keep your chin up"

- (A) To stay cheerful and brave during adversity (B) To practice correct neck posture
(C) To look upward while walking outside (D) To avoid making eye contact

30. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Kill two birds with one stone"

- (A) To accomplish two objectives with a single action (B) To hunt wildlife efficiently in forests
(C) To create unnecessary complications (D) To fail at multiple tasks at once

ANSWER KEY (Q1 - Q30)

Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans
1	(A)	6	(A)	11	(A)	16	(A)	21	(A)	26	(A)
2	(A)	7	(A)	12	(A)	17	(A)	22	(A)	27	(A)
3	(A)	8	(A)	13	(A)	18	(A)	23	(A)	28	(A)
4	(A)	9	(A)	14	(A)	19	(A)	24	(A)	29	(A)
5	(A)	10	(A)	15	(A)	20	(A)	25	(A)	30	(A)